In chapter 3 we looked at tagging the tasks in your PTS system to subjectively indicate whether or not they went well. If you did this, you can now turn that subjective data into objective data.

Agile development is all about the team. You want to be able to create a happy and efficient team that has some ownership of the product they're working on. Asking the team to mark their tasks with how well they think they went is as good an indicator as any to tell you how well your team is doing. A happy team will more likely be a consistently high-performing team. Sad teams may perform well for a time until burnout and attrition destroy them.

In this example a team repeatedly brought up in retrospectives that they thought different roles on the team weren't working together closely enough and it was impacting delivery. They wanted to see more information sharing and collaboration between teams to be able to deliver their products more efficiently and consistently. They decided that they would have more face-to-face conversations and warm hand-off of tasks instead of just assigning tickets to someone else when they thought a task was complete. To track their success they started labeling tasks in their PTS and SCM with the tag "sharing" if they thought that everyone was working together well through the development and delivery cycle. To them *sharing* meant that people were sharing their time and information and generally working together well. In this case they knew development time and recidivism should be low but they didn't have a good idea of how much they should expect their team to comment on their pull requests in source control; they called this "code comment count." Labels, code comment count, recidivism—or the percentage of time tasks move backward in the workflow—and average development time for tasks labeled "sharing" are shown in figure 7.2.

Figure 7.2. Labels, code comment counts, recidivism, and development time for tasks labeled "sharing" over the course of a single sprint